

Global Piracy

A Documentary History of Seaborne Banditry

JAMES E. WADSWORTH



BLOOMSBURY ACADEMIC
LONDON • NEW YORK • OXFORD • NEW DELHI • SYDNEY

CHAPTER FIVE

Dwarf Pirates: Pillaging the Korean and Chinese Coasts

Though largely unknown to most Westerners, Japanese and Chinese piracy thrived in the context of competing states, fragmented geography, vibrant trade and rampant poverty, much like it did in the Western world. It took place in what might be called the Inner Sea – a region that extends from Kamchatka in the northeast to the Malacca Straits in the southeast, bordered by the mainland to the north and west and by the arc of islands from Kamchatka through Japan to Luzon and the northern coast of Borneo.¹ This fragmented coastline, cut by navigable rivers, large bays and dotted with large, inhabited islands, provides the perfect geography for piracy. Rich fisheries, abundant resources, intense geopolitical rivalries, and lucrative and vibrant trade fostered a long tradition of sea raiding. Sometimes these bandits acted independently, sometimes as mercenaries, sometimes in the service of the state and sometimes piratical communities became states themselves. These communities, who often emerged to escape state control of commerce, could become rivals to the very states they had escaped. Pirate communities alternatively competed and cooperated with, ravaged and protected, coerced and extracted from the land-based states.² Smuggling and pillaging also created a shadow economy that acted alongside and often in conjunction with the 'legitimate' state-sanctioned economy. This illicit economy proved crucial in the commercial development of the region and in local state formation.³

What made this region unique in the history of piracy was China. The colossal dominance of China has defined this region for more than 2,000 years. The reason the Straits of Malacca continues to be the busiest shipping lane in the world is China. But the real anomaly of China has been its maritime policy. No other powerful and wealthy nation with a long coastline erected such imposing barriers to seaborne trade. The Ming dynasty (1368–1644)

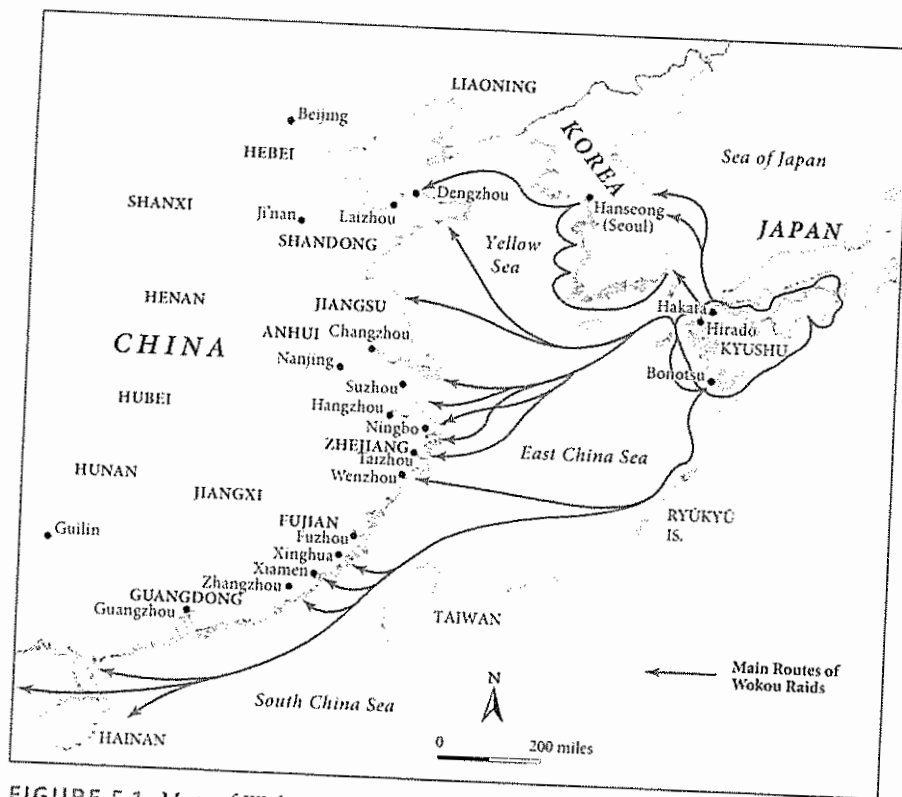


FIGURE 5.1 Map of Wokou pirate raids.

Source: Map produced by Barry Leveley, Cartographer.

attempted to prohibit all seaborne traffic except that associated with official imperial tribute missions.⁴ The Qing dynasty (1644–1911) implemented an even stricter policy. Korea and Japan followed suit and imposed bans on seaborne trade. The Korean Chosŏn rulers (1392–1910) and the Japanese Tokugawa shogunate (1603–1868) both placed tight restrictions on trade and prohibited their subjects from sailing abroad. These prohibitions were often ineffectual and difficult to enforce, but they did foster a vibrant illegal trade carried on by smugglers and pirates of all ethnicities.⁵

Piracy in this region, however, began long before the prohibitions were created. In the tenth century, the Japanese rebel Fujiwara no Sumitomo organized a pirate fleet to attack the imperial Heian fleet. He lost the battle and, subsequently, his head. As the Heian Dynasty (794–1185) collapsed in civil war and the samurai seized political power to rule as shoguns during the Kamakura period (1185–1333), Japanese piracy on the Korean coast intensified. In this period, Japanese pirates, some of whom were probably leaderless and landless samurai cut adrift with the fall of the Taira clan to the Minamoto family in 1185, began to appear in Korean waters. In

1223, they burned and pillaged their way along the Korean coast prompting complaints from the Korean government to the Japanese governor of the southern island of Kyushu from which the pirates originated. In response, the governor of Kyushu 'executed ninety pirates in front of the Korean envoys and sent a letter of apology to the Korean governor'.⁶ Undeterred, the raiders continued to pillage temples, loot storehouses and destroy communities. The primary objects of the raids were food supplies and captives to be used as forced labourers or to be ransomed.⁷ Korean captives and pirate loot were sold at markets in ports such as Naha on Okinawa.⁸ In this sense, the Japanese pirates acted as agents of a forced exchange that existed beside the formal and informal trading economy. The raids continued until the eve of the Mongol invasions of Japan in 1274 and 1281. Following the invasions, piracy spread along the Chinese coast and then back to the Korean coast. By 1350, the raids had become so intense that the Korean state faced economic collapse because of the near-total cessation of maritime traffic.⁹

The Korean government desperately petitioned the Japanese shogunate to put a stop to the pirates, but neither the Japanese government nor the other states in the region could do much to stop it.¹⁰ Not until the overthrow of the Mongol Yuan dynasty in China, the creation of the Ming dynasty there in 1368 and the establishment of the Chosŏn dynasty in Korea in 1392 did an active policy of pirate suppression with the collaboration of the three states emerge.¹¹ The new Ming emperor Hongwu sent missions to Korea and Japan, asking them to control piracy. Tensions remained high as the first Chinese envoy to Japan disappeared and the five members of the second mission were executed. But the Chinese responded, in 1370, by returning fifteen Japanese pirates to Japan and, in 1372, by demanding that the Japanese government do something about the problem. In 1392, the Chosŏn or Yi dynasty emerged in Korea and began sending official missions to Japan seeking an end to piracy. The Korean government finally succeeded in decreasing the pirate threat by 'granting settlement and trade to pirates, thus turning them into traders'.¹² The Japanese government also began to repatriate Korean captives, kidnapped by the pirates. Between 1363 and 1437, some 2,000 Korean captives were sent back to Korea.¹³

The sixteenth century witnessed another surge in piracy in the Inner Sea associated with the Chinese transition to a silver-based economy. Japan possessed massive silver deposits, and smugglers seeking to fill the demand for silver in China could not count on any assistance from the government. They found it necessary to arm themselves for protection against rival bands and soon included piracy in their mix of economic activities. Japan provided safe havens where competing warlords, temples and villages actively sought the foreign commodities and revenue the pirates and smugglers generated.¹⁴

The Koreans called these pirates *waegu* or rioters. The Chinese referred to them as *wokou* or Japanese pirates. The Chinese term combines characters for dwarf, a pejorative term for the Japanese, and one for bandit.¹⁵ *Wokou* became a catchall term used by the educated land-based elite to 'define the

maritime world as a nonagricultural, uncivilized and peripheral region excluded from China proper'.¹⁶

The use of the term 'pirate' for the seafarers of the sixteenth- and seventeenth-century Inner Sea can be misleading, however.¹⁷ These men were entrepreneurs who created networks for long-distance exchange, distribution and production, and other services to land-based patrons. They often controlled maritime chokepoints and created protection rackets.¹⁸ The Seto Inland Sea between Honshu, Kyushu and Skikoku was one such place. Sea lords established themselves in this peripheral region and acted as go-betweens. They set up protection rackets in the narrow channels and offered their services to land-based patrons as sea raiders and trans-shippers of merchandise. Commerce and violence were not seen as contradictory but as integral parts of seafaring identities.¹⁹ Japanese pirates thus succeeded in making themselves indispensable to local lords, called *daimyo*, who legitimized their activities and provided them with social mobility as retainers in the *daimyo*'s household.²⁰

The *Wokou*, however, were not all Japanese. They were, in fact, a hybrid of all the peoples plying the waters of the Inner Sea. Most were Chinese, but the pirate gangs benefitted from cross-cultural pollination including Portuguese and Dutch navigators and weapons, as recent scholars have shown. The pirate ships used a Chinese hull design, employed Western cannon and rigging, carried Japanese warriors and European gunners, navigated by charts produced by the Chinese and the Portuguese, and were manned by mixed crews of Ryukyuan, Japanese, Chinese, Siamese, Spaniards, Portuguese and Dutchmen.²¹

The new surge of piracy decreased after 1567 because the Asian states began relaxing their anti-trade policies. A new Ming policy in 1567 established licensed trade with Southeast Asia, though it still prohibited trade with Japan. A year later, Oda Nobunaga (1534–1582) put an end to Japan's Warring States period (1467–1568) and initiated the red-seal system in 1590 that licensed trade and decreased the autonomy of the warlords. Consequently, the need for smuggling declined and pirates lost access to the Japanese safe havens and patrons who had supported them. The more or less peaceful trade of the 1570s to the 1620s collapsed into another cycle of piratical conflict after the new Tokugawa shogunate of Japan ended the red-seal system, restricted all foreign trade to one port, Nagasaki, and limited foreign trade to Chinese and Dutch merchants.²² This shift occurred at the same time that the Ming began to withdraw its military presence from the sea and turned its attention to the new threat of a unified Jin state in Manchuria to the north. Merchants turned smugglers and smugglers turned pirates. The maritime weakness of the Ming eventually led them to co-opt the pirates they had pursued into their naval system of defences.²³

The most prominent of these Chinese pirates was Zheng Zhilong (d. 1661), who rose from a poor background in Quanzhou region of Fujian to



FIGURE 5.2 Japanese pirate leader with Western revolver.

Source: Photo by Asian Art & Archaeology, Inc./CORBIS/Corbis via Getty Images.

Note: The presence of the European revolver in this image illustrates the international character of the *Wokou* pirates.

command a powerful pirate fleet. After receiving an official rank from the Ming government in 1628 and assigned to control piracy and smuggling, Zheng set about constructing the most powerful maritime/commercial organization of his era. He created links between Fujian seafarers, Portuguese merchants in Macao, 'the Spanish in the Philippines, the Dutch in Taiwan, and the Japanese of Hirado'. Eventually, Zheng controlled 'ninety percent of all Chinese shipping in maritime East Asia'.²⁴

The empire he constructed lasted until 1683, but it struggled with internal dissent, resistance from other pirate/smuggling clans, competition with the Dutch and involvement in the Ming resistance to the Qing dynasty after 1644. The Qing engaged in a long, bitter struggle with the Zheng clan between 1661 and 1683 for control of the Fujian province.²⁵ During this period, the Qing implemented a series of scorched earth policies collectively known as the Exclusion Policy of 1661–1683.²⁶ Under this draconian programme, the Qing attempted to deal with Zheng power by depopulating the coast for a 1,000 kilometres from Zhejiang to Guangdong and for 10 kilometres inland. The residents were simply ordered to evacuate. Those who remained were forcibly removed and the towns and villages put to the torch. In the end, at least 100,000 people perished.

Ultimately, the policy probably helped the Zheng clan more than it hurt them, and it was not until the Qing determined to attack the Zheng base in Taiwan that they succeeded in breaking the family's power. In a classic case of pirate turned pirate hunter, the Qing commissioned an old Zhen ally Shi Lang (1621–1696) who had quarrelled with Koxinga, Zheng's successor, and sent him against his old friends. Shi Lang destroyed the Zheng fleet in 1683. A year later, the Kangxi emperor (b. 1645, reigned 1662–1722) removed the ban on foreign trade and, thus, undermined the motivation for smuggling and piracy.²⁷ Chinese merchants flooded the market cities in Japan and the Philippines, forcing the Dutch East Asian trade into decline. Throughout the eighteenth century, Chinese maritime trade flourished, though the Chinese, the Japanese and the Korean governments continued to regard overseas trade with indifference.²⁸

On the southern end of the Inner Sea, the Gulf of Tonkin took part in the long history of piracy. As a frontier region between China and Vietnam, it suffered near-continuous warfare, low-level conflict and trade bans which stimulated smuggling and piracy. Its fragmented coastline cut by rivers, lagoons, islands, isolated coves and mangrove swamps made it a notoriously difficult region to control. During the Chinese bans on trade and the coastal depopulation policy of the Qing, Vietnam provided safe havens for refugees who often turned to smuggling and piracy.²⁹ Local communities of fishermen, such as the Dan boat people, often combined piracy with fishing, pearl diving and labour as one activity in an overall survival strategy. The bands of smugglers and rebels fleeing state control were often better armed and organized than local pirates. Some settled in the area, but others were *wokou* from Japan operating in the gulf. They were joined by Dutch

pirates in the seventeenth century who first came as traders. But when they became embroiled in local wars, they began pillaging Vietnamese towns and shipping.³⁰

Other pirates came as political rebels fighting against the Manchu conquest of the Ming. They found refuge among competing polities who gave them safe harbours, official titles and outfitted ships in return for a share of the loot and military aid. Local Vietnamese rulers, such as the Nguyễn lords, used pirate-refugees to secure their control of the Mekong delta.³¹

The Inner Sea played a significant role in the political, economic and social construction of the lands washed by its waters. It provided a pathway for trade, diplomacy, warfare and piracy. Contrary to common Western misconceptions, the peoples of this region were not backward and traditional, resistant to change and incapable of competing with Western powers – quite the contrary. These people rapidly overcame any real disadvantages and scored significant victories over Western powers. The seas had always been a place of hybridization, and Asian seafarers readily adopted what worked. They also employed local legal and diplomatic tools to constrain the excesses of Western interlopers. For example, in 1657, the Zheng family sued the Dutch in Japan for capturing a Chinese vessel off the coast of Southern Vietnam. The Japanese court ordered the Dutch to compensate the Zheng, which they had to do or face losing access to the Japanese trade.³²

We should recognize that calling the people we have examined in this chapter pirates is problematic. It represents an acceptance of the establishment narrative and Western (mis)translations of Asian terms that do not necessarily mean pirate in the modern legal sense of that word. These people were labelled bandits by the Chinese establishment, but they were often far more complicated. The *wokou* were a conglomerate of peoples, often merchants, working outside strict sea bans. The Zheng family represented 'pro-commerce resistance against the Manchu conquest of China'.³³ By the middle of the nineteenth century, Japanese sea bandits had been so thoroughly absorbed into the formal power structures and had shifted to smuggling as their primary source of revenue.³⁴ It was, and is, a complicated region where Western terms and concepts often confuse more than they reveal. In the Inner Sea, seaborne banditry was at once parasitic, episodic and intrinsic.

As you read the sources that follow, consider these questions:

- 1 What do these documents reveal about the attitude of government officials towards piracy and pirates?
- 2 What do they reveal about the motives of the pirates?
- 3 How might their motives be tied to government policies?
- 4 What steps did Asian governments take to combat piracy?

- 5 What evidence suggests that these pirates were an international group from a variety of ethnicities?
- 6 What do the *Wokou* pirates reveal about how piracy can shift from parasitic to episodic and how might the geography of the region facilitate or foster the different types of piracy?

Zuikei Shuho and Charlotte von Verschuer, 'Japan's Foreign Relations 1200 to 1392 CE: A Translation from "Zenrin Kokuhōki"', *Monumenta Nipponica*, vol. 57, no. 4 (Winter, 2002): 438, 442. Used with permission.

Letter from Korea to the shogun of Japan, 1367.

Too many pirates from your country [Japan] come [to Korea] and plunder the port Happon and other places in this region. They set fire to administrative buildings and trouble the inhabitants, at the worst even killing people. This has gone on for more than ten years. Merchant ships are unable to travel freely and the people in the vicinity cannot live in peace.

Letter from Ashikaga Yoshimitsu to T'aijo Chosŏn of Korea, 1392.

He transmitted a letter from Your Excellencies, to the government of our great shogun [Ashikaga Yoshimitsu] saying that piracy on the seas still has not ceased and that this is hurting [the relations between] our two countries. The situation is indeed as it has been said [many times] before. It would be truly shameful for the rulers of our country to abandon the effort to instruct the coastal people in proper behavior. [The shogun] once more ordered his vassal, the governor of Kyushu [Imagawa Sadayo], to ban and seize [Japanese] pirates' ships and to free and return their [Korean] prisoners to your country. I am sure that eventually good neighborly relations between our two countries will be resumed, providing continuous happiness to you, our benefactor. This is indeed our wish.

Kwan-wai So, *Japanese Piracy in Ming China during the 16th Century* (East Lansing: Michigan State University press, 1975), 15–16, 23, 31, 57–58. Used with permission.

Report by Japanese Pirate: Memoirs of Sato Shinen no shuki, 1570s.

During the Eisho and Taiei eras (1504–1527) several warriors ... from islands ... off the coast of Iyo banded together and crossed the ocean to foreign lands, where they operated as pirates and became wealthy. Murakami Zusho, the lord of Noshima, was selected as their leader. The pirates pillaged coastal towns and seized all kinds of things, making themselves rich. They operated along the coast of China ..., and among the islands of southeast as far as the Philippines, Borneo, and Bali. For several years they continued these forays In time ronins, fishermen, scoundrels, and others from the Kyushu-Shikoku area joined the pirate

bands, and gradually their size increased from eight to nine hundred to over a thousand men. Consequently, all the islands of the southwestern seas were harassed by pirates. Even Ming China feared them, and as a result sent out her huge armies (to drive them away). China also strengthened her coastal defenses. It was at this time that the pirates came to be known as Wako

Iida Koichiro of Oshima in the province of Iyo and Kitaura Kanjuro of Momojima in the province of Bingo were the first (pirate leaders) to sail to foreign lands, pillage the coastal villages, steal property and enrich their families. It is said that at first the two leaders had only fifty or sixty men under them, but with each raid their profits mounted considerably and, as a result, the bands became larger and more powerful.

In foreign countries soldiers were drawn up to guard the coast against our raids. Consequently, we increased our military strength. If we could not destroy the armies, guarding the coast, we could gain no profit. Therefore, before setting sail we made complete preparations for engaging such armies in battle. In regard to these preparations, Wu and Sung had a large number of guns and it became necessary to take proper countermeasures. Toward the end of the Tembun era (1554) we adopted the use of guns, which increased our military strength and enlarged the size of the pirate bands. In 1555, the number of men in the seven groups reached a total of more than 1,000. Each ship was loaded with 700 koku of rice. There were eight or nine main vessels, the best of which were called Hagaibune In 1563 our seven bands totaling 1,300 men, attacked Ping-hai in Ming China We had one hundred and thirty-seven vessels of various sizes The total number of pirates of all classes reached the figure of 1,352 men, plus 60 fishermen and the like who made up the crew. Of the above two or three hundred Chinese pirates had joined our ranks

Wang Yü, Memorials by His Excellency Wang Ssu-chih, the Censor in Chief, 1552–1554.

Who have caused this? Generally speaking, the pirates on the high seas are of many different groups. Those who have raided this year do not belong to one group alone. There are notorious pirates of Fukien and Kwangtung who have allied with the Wo (Japanese) and come from Japan: such as T'ien Lao, who attacked Sung-men and Ning-hai; Wang Lao, who attacked Ch'ang-kuo and Hsiang-shan; Li La-ta and Lin Chih, who attacked Hsin-ho and Ai-wan; Ts'en Lao, who attacked Cha-p'u and Cheng Lao, who attacked Shanghai and Tai-ts'ang are all of one group.

There are treacherous people from Wen [-chou] and Ning [-po] [of Chekiang] who have fled to Japan (and they) number in the thousands. [Their] living abodes have formed lanes or villages, with streets named Ta-t'ang (the Great T'ang). They have induced the famished Japanese people to come as pirates. Such as Mao Lao and P'u Lao, who attacked

Lin-shan and those who occupied Chou-shan, the garrison posts of Ts'en-kang and Kuo-ch'u, form another group.

There are wealthy merchants and traders who own huge men-of-war and crack troops and dominate the seas. Having invited the barbarians to join them. They act recklessly and oppressively. Among these are Wang Chih, Hsü Wei, hsüeh, Mao Hsun, Hsü Ming-shan, Li San, and others. They have occupied Lieh-kang and have recently returned from their trading trip eastward. These form another group

Ming historian and magistrate Hsüeh Ying-ch'I, "The Rectification of Names," 1535.

Now the pirates have penetrated deep into our land. The cruelty of their killing, plundering, burning and destroying has never been matched since olden times. Certainly, they want to call themselves by the name Wo. But if we also call them Wo, we would have fallen into their tricks, for we have failed to say that they are really not Wo. It is because, in truth, the rebels of our Middle Kingdom have served as their ringleaders and guides and have invited the Wo barbarians to be their helpers. By the name Wo then they can hide themselves and get under cover, and their families and relatives would be protected from danger. [They would] say that the pirates of today are the Wo and they have taken no part [in the piracy]. Consequently, they could come back with loads of gold, silk, and commodities.

Confession of Chinese smugglers, 1546.

On the 2nd day of the 5th month [June 7] I myself [Ch'en] went ashore on an island and was caught by the patrol. On that day there were on board only twenty Japanese barbarians and there were Japanese swords, Japanese bows, two jars of explosives, four small-size Portuguese cannon, four or five bird-peaked guns, all of which had been obtained by the barbarians in a fight back in Japan the previous year. Among the people aboard were fifty Chinese. Of these six or seven were Cantonese, three or four natives of Chang-chow, more than ten natives of Hui-chow, more than ten natives of Ningpo, and four natives of Shaohsing.

Albert Hastings Markham, ed., 'The Second Voyage of John Davis with Sir Edward Michelborne ...', in *The Voyages of Works of John Davis, the Navigator* (London: Hakluyt Society, 1880), 178-182.

Here as I stood for Patane about the twenty-seventh of December [1604], I met with a junk of the Japanese which had been pirating along the coast of China and Cambodia. Their pilot being dead, with ignorance and foul weather they had cast away their ship on the shoals of the great island of Borneo; and to enter into the country of Borneo, they durst not. For the Japanese are not suffered to land in any port of India with weapons;

being accounted a people so desperate and daring that they are feared in all places where they come.

These people, their ship being splitted, with their shallops entered the junk wherein I met them, which was of Patane, and killed all the people save one old pilot. This junk was laden with rice, which, when they had possessed and furnished with such furniture, necessities, and arms as they saved out of their sunken ship, they shaped their course for Japan; but the badness of their junk, contrary winds, and unreasonableness of the year forced them to leeward; which was the cause of my unlucky meeting them.

After I had hailed them, and made them come to leeward, sending my boat aboard them, I found them by their men and furniture very unproportionable for such a ship as they were in; which was a junk not above seventy tons in burden, and they were ninety men and most of them in too gallant a habit for sailors, and such an equality of behavior among them there was that they called captain, but gave him little respect. I caused them to come to an anchor, and upon further examination I found their lading to be only rice; and for the most part spoilt with wet, for their ship was leaking both under and above water. Upon questioning with them, I understood them to be men of war that had pillaged on the coast to China and Cambodia and as I said before, had cast away their ship on the shoals of Borneo.

Here we rode at anchor under a small island near the isle of Bintang, two days entertaining them with good usage, not taking anything from them; thinking to have gathered by their knowledge the place and passage of certain ships on the coast of China to have made my voyage. But these rogues being desperate in winds and fortunes, being hopeless in that paltry junk ever to return to their country, resolved with themselves either to gain my ship or to lose their lives.

And upon mutual courtesies, with gifts and feastings between us, sometimes five and twenty or six and twenty of their chieftest came aboard; whereof I would not suffer above six to have weapons. There was never the like number of our men aboard their junk.

I willed Captain John Davis in the morning to possess himself of their weapons, and to put the company before mast, and to leave some guard on their weapons while they searched in the rice, doubting that by searching and finding that which would dislike them they might suddenly set upon my men and put them to the sword; as the sequel proved.

Captain Davis, being beguiled with their humble semblance, would not possess himself of their weapons, though I sent twice of purpose from my ship to will him to do it. They passed all the day, my men searching in the rice and they looking on. At the sun setting, after long search and nothing found, save a little storax and benzoin, they seeing opportunity, and taking the rest of their company which were in my ship being near to their junk, they resolved at a watchword between them, to set upon us

resolutely in both ships. This being concluded they suddenly killed and drave overboard all my men that were in their ship; and those which were aboard my ship sallied out of my cabin, where they were put, with such weapons as they had, finding certain targets in my cabin, and other things that they used as weapons. My self being aloft on the deck, knowing what was likely to follow, leapt into the waste, where, with the boatswain, carpenter and some few more we kept them under the half deck.

At their first coming forth of the cabin, they met Captain Davis coming out of the gunroom, whom they pulled into the cabin, and giving him six or seven mortal wounds they thrust him out of the cabin before them. His wounds were so mortal that he died as soon as he came into the waste. They pressed so fiercely to come to us, as we receiving them on our pikes, they would gather on our pikes with their hands to reach us with their swords. It was near half an hour before we could stone them back into the cabin. In which time we had killed three or four of their leaders.

After they were driven into the cabin, they fought with us at least four hours before we could suppress them, often firing the cabin, burning the bedding, and much other stuff that was there. And had we not with two demy-culverins,³⁵ from under the half deck, beaten down the bulk head and the pump of the ship we could not have suppressed them from burning the ship. This ordinance being charged with crossbars, bullets, and case shot and bent close to the bulk head, so violently marred therewith boards and splinters that left but one of them standing of two and twenty. Their legs, arms and bodies were so torn as it was strange to see how the shot had massacred them.

In all this conflict, they never would desire their lives, though they were hopeless to escape; such was the desperateness of these Japanese. Only one leapt over board, which afterward swam to our ship again and asked for grace. We took him in and asked him what was their purpose.

He told us that they meant to take our ship and to cut all our throats. He would say no more, but desired that he might be cut in pieces.

The next day, to wit, the eight and twentieth of December, we went to a little island to the leeward of us. And when we were about five miles from land, the general commanded his people to hand him to the Japanese. But he brake the rope and fell into the sea. I cannot tell whether he swam to land or not.

Notes

- 1 Robinson, 'Centering the King of Chosŏn', 110.
- 2 MacKay, 'Pirate Nations', 552, 567–568.
- 3 Chin, 'Merchants, Smugglers, and Pirates', 43–57.
- 4 Ravina, 'Japan in the Chinese Tribute System', 353–363.

- 5 Andrade and Hang, 'Introduction', 3–6.
- 6 Shuho and Verschuer, 'Japan's Foreign Relations', 417.
- 7 Robinson, 'Centering the King of Chosŏn', 112.
- 8 Robinson, 'Centering the King of Chosŏn', 112.
- 9 Shuho and Verschuer, 'Japan's Foreign Relations', 418.
- 10 Shapinsky, 'Envoys and Escorts', 38–64.
- 11 Shuho and Verschuer, 'Japan's Foreign Relations', 418.
- 12 Shuho and Verschuer, 'Japan's Foreign Relations', 440, fn. 72 and 442, fn. 74.
- 13 Robinson, 'Centering the King of Chosŏn', 113.
- 14 So, *Japanese Piracy*, 16–36; Andrade and Hang, 'Introduction', 6–8.
- 15 Antony, 'Introduction', 7.
- 16 Shapinsky, 'Envoys and Escorts', 41.
- 17 Reid, 'Violence at Sea', 18.
- 18 Shapinsky, 'Predators, and Purveyors', 274, 304.
- 19 Shapinsky, 'From Sea Bandits to Sea Lords', 28–30.
- 20 Petrucci, 'Pirates, Gunpowder, and Christianity', 59–71.
- 21 Batchelor, 'Maps, Calendars, and Diagrams', 86–113; Andrade and Hang, 'Introduction', 8.
- 22 Andrade and Hang, 'Introduction', 8–11; Clulow, 'Like Lambs in Japan', 335–358.
- 23 Andrade and Hang, 'Introduction', 11.
- 24 Andrade and Hang, 'Introduction', 11–12.
- 25 Chin, 'A Hokkien Maritime Empire', 93–112.
- 26 Ho, 'The Burning Shore', 260–289.
- 27 Andrade and Hang, 'Introduction', 17–18.
- 28 Andrade and Hang, 'Introduction', 20–21.
- 29 Antony, 'Trade, Piracy, and Resistance', 312–316.
- 30 Antony, 'Trade, Piracy, and Resistance', 320–326.
- 31 Antony, 'Trade, Piracy, and Resistance', 327–330.
- 32 Clulow, 'Determining the Law of the Sea', 181–198.
- 33 Reid, 'Violence at Sea', 18.
- 34 Hellyer, 'Poor but not Pirates', 113–126.
- 35 A medium-sized cannon about eleven feet long with a four-inch bore.